

Schrödinger dating app: Where preference and information meet, yet aren't allowed to collaborate.

MADS – Ethics assignment 2

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First impression

The main ethical issue that's affecting Breeze is that the algorithm seems to discriminate against dark-skinned and non-Dutch originating users, based on users reporting a lack of diversity in suggested dating candidates. Breeze suspects that this is a result of dark-skinned and non-Dutch originating users quitting the application, since they rarely get matches.

Based on the part *Complaints about diversity*, I get the impression that the algorithm correlates likes to matching probability in general. Therefore the more likes someone gets – whether there are eventual matches or not – the more they are suggested to other users. Conversely, candidates with less likes are suggested less in its entirety (College voor de Rechten van de Mens, 2023).

Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG)

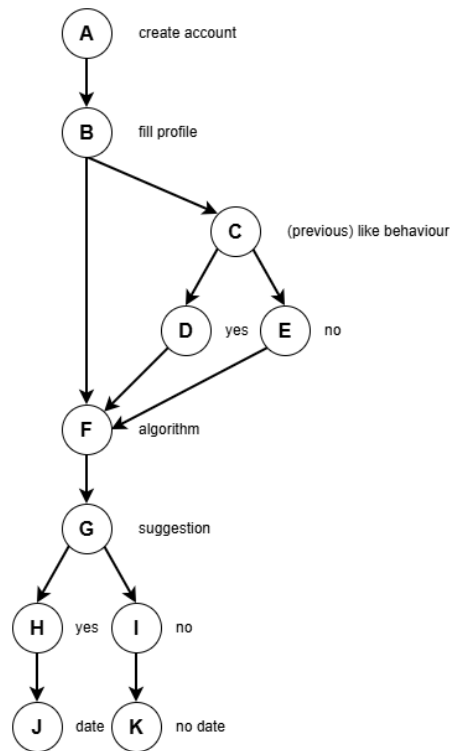
Rooted in my impression of the article, the dilemma Breeze is facing regards fairness in candidate suggestions while being restricted in their use of personal data concerning origin or skin color. The Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG) below represents the journey of a single Breeze user and how their choices affect the algorithm and thus influences the given suggestions (GeeksForGeeks, 2025).

Second impression

Aspects that were not mentioned in *First impression* – since they are more detailed – is the debate the algorithm can spark concerning the content and weight of various parts of the given input. To me, there are two features that need to be seriously discussed:

- The weight personal preference will be given in the algorithm
- How one's ethnicity should be defined, since specific personal data concerning origin or skin color is not allowed to be processed according to the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

Aforementioned features form the crux of the dilemma, almost fully contradicting one another. How is one supposed to take personal preference into account when not allowed to use – all – data contributing to personal preference?



Recommendations

If a Data Scientist would take part in this project, I'd recommend them to do the following:

- Perform loads of scientific research:
 - Has this happened to similar situations in the past?
 - What were the repercussions?
 - How has this been dealt with?
 - How have similar problems been adapted over time?
 - Etc.
- Make sure the resulting algorithm is regularly inspected to avoid it teaching itself (positive) discrimination. In case there are signs during inspection, an intervention can cause the algorithm to correct itself.

Bibliography

College voor de Rechten van de Mens. (2023, September 6). *Dating app Breeze mag en moet algoritme aanpassen om discriminatie te voorkomen*. Received from Mensenrechten: <https://www.mensenrechten.nl/actueel/nieuws/2023/09/06/dating-app-breeze-mag-en-moet-algoritme-aanpassen-om-discriminatie-te-voorkomen>

GeeksForGeeks. (2025, July 23). *Introduction to Directed Acyclic Graph*. Received from Geeks for Geeks: <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/dsa/introduction-to-directed-acyclic-graph/>